PRESENT TENSES

English class

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GRAMMAR MAP

4 present tenses

forms + time words + examples

Four present tenses, four perspectives

PRESENT SIMPLE

routine / fact

I work every day.

Trabajo todos los días.

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

now / temporary

I am working now.

Estoy trabajando ahora.

PRESENT PERFECT

past connected to now

I have finished.

He terminado.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

activity up to now

I have been working.

He estado trabajando.

Present Simple: the essential form

Short form guide

AFFIRMATIVE

I / You / We / They work

He / She / It works

NEGATIVE

I don't work

She doesn't work

QUESTION

Do you work?

Does she work?

REMEMBER

After does / doesn't, use the base verb: Does she work?

Routines, facts and schedules

I usually walk to work.

Normalmente voy andando al trabajo.

Water boils at 100°C.

El agua hierve a 100 °C.

The lesson starts at nine.

La clase empieza a las nueve.

My brother lives in Seville.

Mi hermano vive en Sevilla.

She plays tennis on Fridays.

Ella juega al tenis los viernes.

I think this answer is correct.

Creo que esta respuesta es correcta.

How often? Position gives meaning

always	usually	often	sometimes	rarely	never
100%	80%	60%	40%	20%	0%

MOST VERBS

She often studies at night.

Ella estudia a menudo por la noche.

VERB TO BE

They are usually friendly.

Normalmente son amables.

Typical time expressions

every day

on Mondays

once a week

at weekends

in the morning

from time to time

We have English twice a week.

Tenemos inglés dos veces por semana.

He sometimes cooks at weekends.

A veces cocina los fines de semana.

Present Continuous: BE + verb-ing

Compact form guide

AFFIRMATIVE

I am working

They are working

NEGATIVE

I'm not working

She isn't working

QUESTION

Are you working?

Is he working?

write -> writing run -> running lie -> lying

Now, temporary situations and arrangements

Listen! The baby is crying.

¡Escucha! El bebé está llorando.

Prices are rising quickly.

Los precios están subiendo rápidamente.

He's always losing his keys!

¡Siempre está perdiendo las llaves!

I'm staying with my aunt this week.

Esta semana me quedo con mi tía.

We're meeting Sara at six.

Hemos quedado con Sara a las seis.

What are you doing right now?

¿Qué estás haciendo ahora mismo?

Clues for actions happening around now

now	right now	at the moment	today
this week	these days	currently	tonight

I'm reading a very good book these days.

Estos días estoy leyendo un libro muy bueno.

We're having dinner with Ana tonight.

Esta noche cenamos con Ana.

Routine or situation around now?

ROUTINE

I cycle to college every day.

Voy en bici a la universidad todos los días.

She works in a café.

Ella trabaja en una cafetería.

AROUND NOW

I'm cycling because my car is broken.

Voy en bici porque mi coche está averiado.

She's working from home today.

Hoy está trabajando desde casa.

Some verbs rarely use the continuous form

THOUGHTS

know, understand, believe, remember

FEELINGS

love, like, hate, prefer, want

SENSES / POSSESSION

see, hear, smell, belong, own, have

I understand the question.

Entiendo la pregunta.

I'm understanding the question.

Forma normalmente incorrecta.

Same verb, different meaning

I think you're right.

Creo que tienes razón.

I'm thinking about the problem.

Estoy pensando en el problema.

She has a new laptop.

Ella tiene un portátil nuevo.

She's having lunch.

Está comiendo.

This soup tastes good.

Esta sopa sabe bien.

The chef is tasting the soup.

El cocinero está probando la sopa.

I see your point.

Entiendo tu punto de vista.

I'm seeing the dentist tomorrow.

Mañana voy al dentista.

Present Perfect: have / has + past participle

AFFIRMATIVE

I have finished

She has finished

NEGATIVE

I haven't finished

He hasn't finished

QUESTION

Have you finished?

Has she finished?

Regular: worked Irregular: done, seen, written, gone

Past action with a connection to now

RESULT NOW

I've lost my keys.

He perdido las llaves.

LIFE EXPERIENCE

She has visited Japan.

Ella ha visitado Japón.

UNFINISHED TIME

We've had three tests this month.

Hemos tenido tres exámenes este mes.

FROM PAST TO NOW

I have known Luis for years.

Conozco a Luis desde hace años.

Already, just, yet and still

Position matters

ALREADY

before now, often sooner than expected

I've already sent the email.

Ya he enviado el correo.

JUST

a very short time ago

She has just arrived.

Acaba de llegar.

YET

questions and negatives, usually at the end

Have you finished yet?

¿Has terminado ya?

STILL

the situation continues

I still haven't finished.

Todavía no he terminado.

Ever, never, before and so far

Have you ever ridden a horse?

¿Has montado alguna vez a caballo?

I've never tried sushi.

Nunca he probado sushi.

We have met before.

Nos hemos visto antes.

So far, everything has gone well.

Hasta ahora, todo ha ido bien.

This is the best film I've ever seen.

Es la mejor película que he visto nunca.

Have you been abroad recently?

¿Has estado en el extranjero últimamente?

Duration up to now

FOR + PERIOD

for two hours

for a long time

I've lived here for ten years.

Vivo aquí desde hace diez años.

SINCE + STARTING POINT

since 2022

since I was a child

She's worked here since May.

Trabaja aquí desde mayo.

How long have you known Marta?

¿Desde cuándo conoces a Marta?

Two participles, two locations

HAS BEEN TO

went and came back

Leo has been to Paris twice.

Leo ha estado en París dos veces.

I've never been to Ireland.

Nunca he estado en Irlanda.

HAS GONE TO

went and is still there

Leo has gone to Paris.

Leo ha ido a París y sigue allí.

Mum has gone to the shops.

Mamá ha ido a las tiendas.

Finished time or unfinished time?

PAST SIMPLE

finished time: yesterday, last week, in 2020

I saw Ana yesterday.

Vi a Ana ayer.

We moved here in 2020.

Nos mudamos aquí en 2020.

PRESENT PERFECT

time connected to now: today, this week, ever

I've seen Ana today.

He visto a Ana hoy.

We've lived here since 2020.

Vivimos aquí desde 2020.

Have / has been + verb-ing

AFFIRMATIVE

I have been studying

She has been studying

NEGATIVE

I haven't been sleeping

He hasn't been sleeping

QUESTION

Have you been waiting?

Has it been raining?

I've been learning English for three years.

Llevo tres años aprendiendo inglés.

Duration, recent activity and visible results

I've been working since eight.

Llevo trabajando desde las ocho.

She has been studying all morning.

Lleva estudiando toda la mañana.

It has been raining. The streets are wet.

Ha estado lloviendo. Las calles están mojadas.

Why are you tired? Have you been running?

¿Por qué estás cansado? ¿Has estado corriendo?

We've been waiting for forty minutes.

Llevamos cuarenta minutos esperando.

He's been using my laptop again.

Ha estado usando mi portátil otra vez.

Clues for the perfect continuous

for	since	all day	all morning
lately	recently	how long?	for ages

How long have you been waiting?

¿Cuánto tiempo llevas esperando?

I've been feeling tired lately.

Últimamente me he sentido cansado/a.

Result, quantity or activity?

PRESENT PERFECT

result / completion / how many

I've written three emails.

He escrito tres correos.

She has cleaned the kitchen.

Ha limpiado la cocina.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

activity / duration / visible process

I've been writing emails all morning.

Llevo toda la mañana escribiendo correos.

She has been cleaning the kitchen.

Ha estado limpiando la cocina.

State verbs, repeated actions and completion

KNOW	I've known her for years.	I have been knowing her.	*state verb*
HAVE	I've had this phone since May.	I've been having this phone since May.	*possession*
READ	I've read the book.	I've been reading the book.	*finished / in progress*
WRITE	She's written five pages.	She's been writing all afternoon.	*quantity / duration*

One situation, four present tenses

PRESENT SIMPLE

I read before bed.

Leo antes de dormir.

PRESENT CONTINUOUS

I'm reading a mystery novel.

Estoy leyendo una novela de misterio.

PRESENT PERFECT

I've read three books this month.

He leído tres libros este mes.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

I've been reading for two hours.

Llevo dos horas leyendo.

Six errors you can fix quickly

✕ She work every day.	✓ She works every day.
✕ I am agree with you.	✓ I agree with you.
✕ I have seen him yesterday.	✓ I saw him yesterday.
✕ Have you finished already?	✓ Have you finished yet?
✕ I live here since 2022.	✓ I've lived here since 2022.
✕ I've been knowing her for years.	✓ I've known her for years.

Choose the best tense

1. Leo usually _____ (play) football after school.
2. Be quiet! The baby _____ (sleep).
3. I _____ just _____ (finish) my homework.
4. We _____ (wait) for the bus for 30 minutes.
5. _____ you ever _____ (try) Indian food?
6. She _____ (know) Marta since primary school.
7. They _____ (meet) us at eight tonight.

THINK

form + meaning + time clue

Answer key and reasons

1. plays	routine + usually
2. is sleeping	happening now
3. have just finished	recent result
4. have been waiting	duration up to now
5. Have / tried	life experience
6. has known	state verb + since
7. are meeting	future arrangement

PRESENT TENSES Choose the tense that shows your meaning.